

WHY AM I ME, AND WHY NOT YOU?

WINGS OF DESIRE / 1987

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

New German Cinema

DIRECTOR

Wim Wenders

WRITERS

Wim Wenders, Peter Handke, Richard Reitinger

STARS

Bruno Ganz, Solveig Dommartin, Otto Sander, Curt Bois, Peter Falk

BEFORE

1953 Yasujiro Ozu's *Tokyo Story* shows everyday life as a struggle of quiet desperation.

1972 Andrei Tarkovsky meditates on existence with *Solaris*, a slow-paced science-fiction movie.

AFTER

1993 Wenders' sequel to *Wings of Desire* is *Faraway, So Close!*

Inspired by the visionary poetry of Rainer Maria Rilke and scripted by the playwright Peter Handke, Wim Wenders' *Wings of Desire* (*Der Himmel über Berlin*) is both a moving allegory of Berlin—just two years before the fall of the Wall—and a poignant study of the need for love and what it means to be human. It is the

story of an angel, tired of his immortal life of care, who falls in love with a circus trapeze artist—and of another, played by Peter Falk, who has already found contentment by crossing over.

The angels Daniel (Bruno Ganz) and Cassiel (Otto Sander) are an invisible presence in people's lives.

